

Growing up

Throughout life, everyone goes through the same stages of growth and development. The biggest changes happen between birth and the late teens—from a baby totally reliant on its parents to an independent young adult.

Early years

Infancy, childhood, and adolescence are years of great change. During this time, the brain develops very quickly, making new connections that enable us to communicate, move, and behave in more sophisticated ways. The body also changes in appearance, eventually taking on the shape and size of an adult body.

The first year of life is called **infancy**. An infant grows rapidly and progresses from lying to sitting to crawling, then standing up, and finally walking. Infants grasp objects and interact with people using sounds and facial expressions.



During **childhood**, between the ages of one and 10, the proportions of a child's body change, with limbs growing longer. The brain develops rapidly and children learn to speak and read, run and jump, and pick up life skills.

